Kevin Trayner

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Overview

Product & Strategic Design Leader with 20+ years driving experience vision and customer-centric strategies for Fortune 100 enterprises, translating complex business problems into seamless digital products that scale to 150M+ users. Expert at bridging CX, product, and executive stakeholders to reduce friction, and ship work that moves fast and solves real problems.

Skills

- **Design & Strategy:** Product Design | Experience Architecture | Service Design and Blueprinting | Design Systems and Governance | Journey Mapping.
- **Leadership & Execution:** Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Agile/SDLC | Friction Audits | Stakeholder Alignment | Design Mentorship.
- **Tools & Artifacts:** Wireframing & Prototyping | Figma Component Libraries | Generative AI for UX (Gemini | Claude Code | Copilot).

Relevant Work Experience

- **Define a common design vision that balances business and customer needs.** *Case Study: Create a design strategy and journey map for a new Satellite service*.
- **Bring clarity to ambiguous problem spaces, and turn them into shipped products, working to prioritize work with other teams and third-party partners.** *Case Study: Own the end-to-end experience, and remove ambiguity for a new streaming launch*.
- **Shape products from high level vision, to detail design, to execution across multiple channels, products and teams**. *Case Study: Build an end to end experience across channels, functions and business units for FCC labels.*
- **Use research, prototyping, early testing and iterative design to incrementally improve, and revamp an experience architecture.** *Case Study: Redesign our core mobile plans architecture from early concept through to delivery*.
- **Champion design craft and organization-wide process:** Mentor junior designers, partner weekly with the Verizon Design System team to identify and build forward-looking patterns and lead design critiques to continually elevate team standards and ways of working.
- **Incorporate AI into design work:** Use agentic and generative AI (Gemini, Claude Code, Copilot, Figma Make) strategically to improve work flow - brief creation, competitive analysis, journey mapping, prototyping, research, and more - but keep the human in the lead. Examples of how I use AI in projects.

Experience

Verizon Consumer Group (VCG) - Basking Ridge, NJ

Lead design strategist for mobile and related digital products for a 150 million customer base.

Principal Experience Designer / Architect (2024 – Present)

- **Define Experience Vision:** Lead end-to-end design strategy for mobile products, identify and close experience architecture conflicts and gaps, and untangle complex problems into simple digital journeys for customers.
- **Refine and redesign our mobile plans architecture:** Address current friction points in our mobile plans today, and create a vision to distinguish Verizon from the competition with myPlans, by simplifying customer choice and encouraging higher-value plans. The myPlans mobile plan launch saw around 13 million subscribers after its initial rollout, and is used by more than half of our 150 million wireless customers.
- **Design system & process governance:** Created reusable Figma templates and guidance to help launch new promotions faster. Met weekly with Verizon Design System (VDS) team to identify and build forward-looking patterns, work with the accessibility team to ensure compliance in our VDS patterns.
- **Cross-functional alignment & stakeholder leadership:** Led collaborative workshops with business, product, and design leaders to solve technical issues and align cross-channel strategies.
- **Mentorship & practice development:** Mentored junior and mid-level designers on design skills, system thinking, and presentations, and led design critiques to continually elevate team standards and improve our ways of working.

Lead Experience Designer (2021 – 2024)

- **Reduce friction/improve experience for mobile sales, increasing revenue:** Worked with our CX director to reduce friction and increase conversion for our add a line experience, contributing to $8.4M/mo in revenue (and was recognized with a GOAT award).
- **Own end-to-end experience for new streaming launch:** Launched a new streaming combo service (Netflix/Max) that fit the existing service model, satisfied our partners, and removed ambiguity for customers. Remains Verizon's second-best-selling perk, on nearly 11 million mobile accounts.
- **Modernized product experience to increase sales:** Led CX updates for connected device plans (tablets and smartwatches), directly contributing to tablet premium plan activations performing 3.3% above forecast.
- **Partner with business, developers, designers, CX, and legal from high level vision to detail design experience across multiple channels, products and teams:** Led the UX design and cross-platform implementation for FCC-mandated product labels across all mobile and home services across the entire Verizon ecosystem, meeting legal requirements without negatively impacting the plans experience.

Senior UX Designer (2016 – 2021)

- Optimized the Learn & Buy sales funnel on Verizon.com, enhancing web and mobile journeys for 115M users.
- Delivered high-fidelity wireframes, interactive prototypes, and user flows in close collaboration with development and brand teams.

Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu - Princeton, NJ

Envision, deliver and support products used by 80,000 client service professionals in 32 countries to perform their daily work on audit engagements - a $20 billion revenue stream today.

Senior Business Analyst/Designer (2010 – 2016)

- Created and managed user requirements and experience design for internal software used by 80,000 professionals across 32 countries.
- Validated experiences through surveys, interviews, and regular UAT and usability testing with real users.
- Delivered both desktop and web applications from high level concept to wireframe, including

personas, styles, controls, navigation, site maps, page flows, and prototypes.

User Experience Designer (2004 – 2010)

- Designed enterprise web/desktop applications, delivering wireframes, process flows, site maps, and UI pattern libraries.
- Wrote comprehensive user guides and support materials to help employees worldwide adopt new software.

Multimedia Specialist (2001 – 2004)

- Developed interactive product demos and visual prototypes to support global software rollouts.

Technical Writer (1995 – 2001)

- Authored user documentation and help guides for desktop applications serving 20,000 global users.

Additional Experience

Instructional Designer - Eduneering
Designed interactive computer-based training modules for Fortune 500 clients in the energy and telecommunications industries for small, start up tech consulting firm. (Owned by UL Solutions today).

Editor - Cranbury Publications
Managed production, design, and writing staff for local newspapers and oversaw the startup of a new publication.

Education and Certifications

• **Google AI Professional Certificate** — Coursera / Google (2026).
• **BA in English / Communications** — Ursinus College, Collegeville, PA.

Leadership and Publications

• **Board of Trustees** — Murray Grove Retreat Center, Lanoka Harbor, NJ. Provide oversight, strategic direction, and governance for a 20 acre retreat focused on radical hospitality.
• **Published Author & Columnist** — Author of *Beer Drinker's Handbook* | Columnist for Ale Street News.